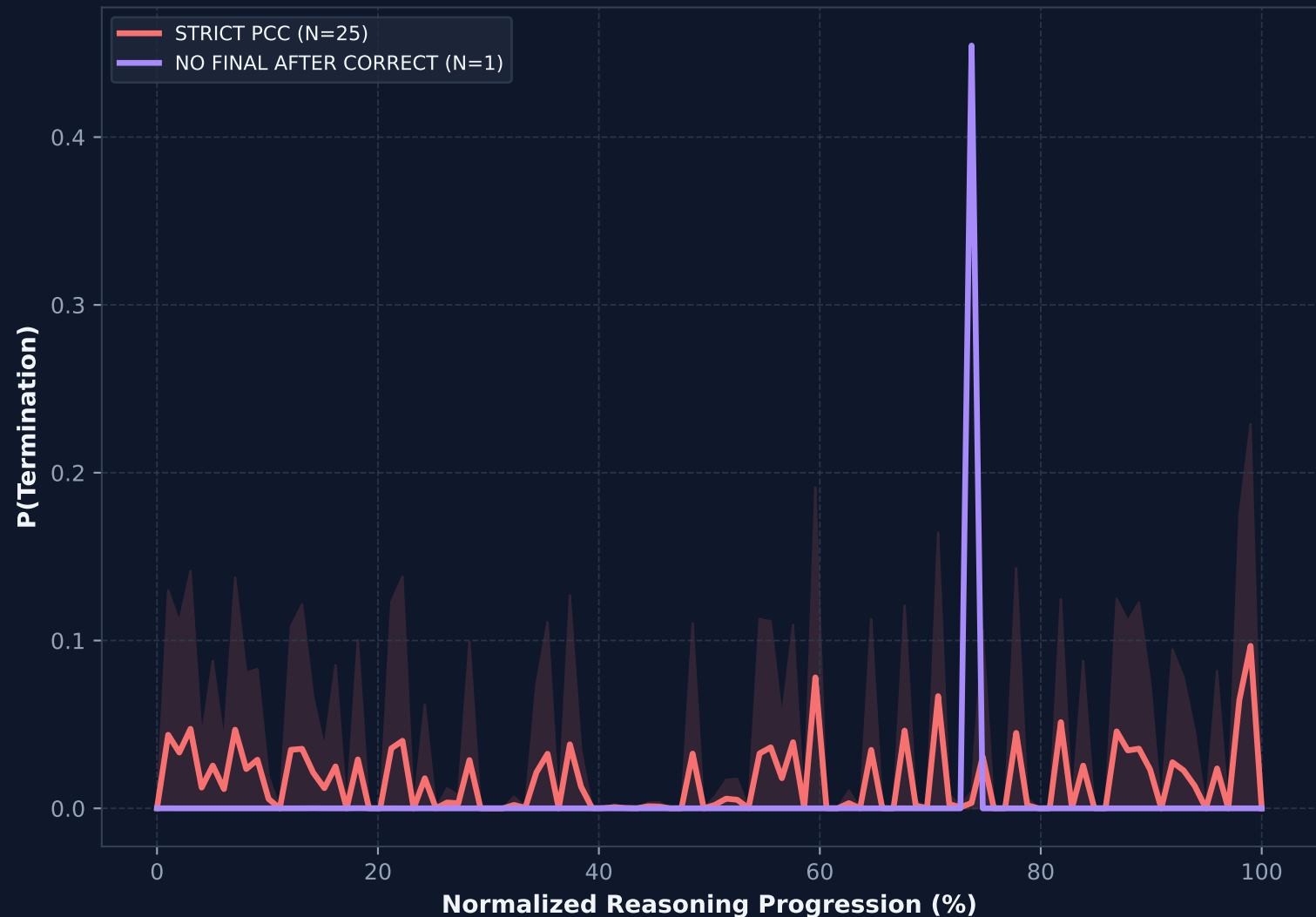
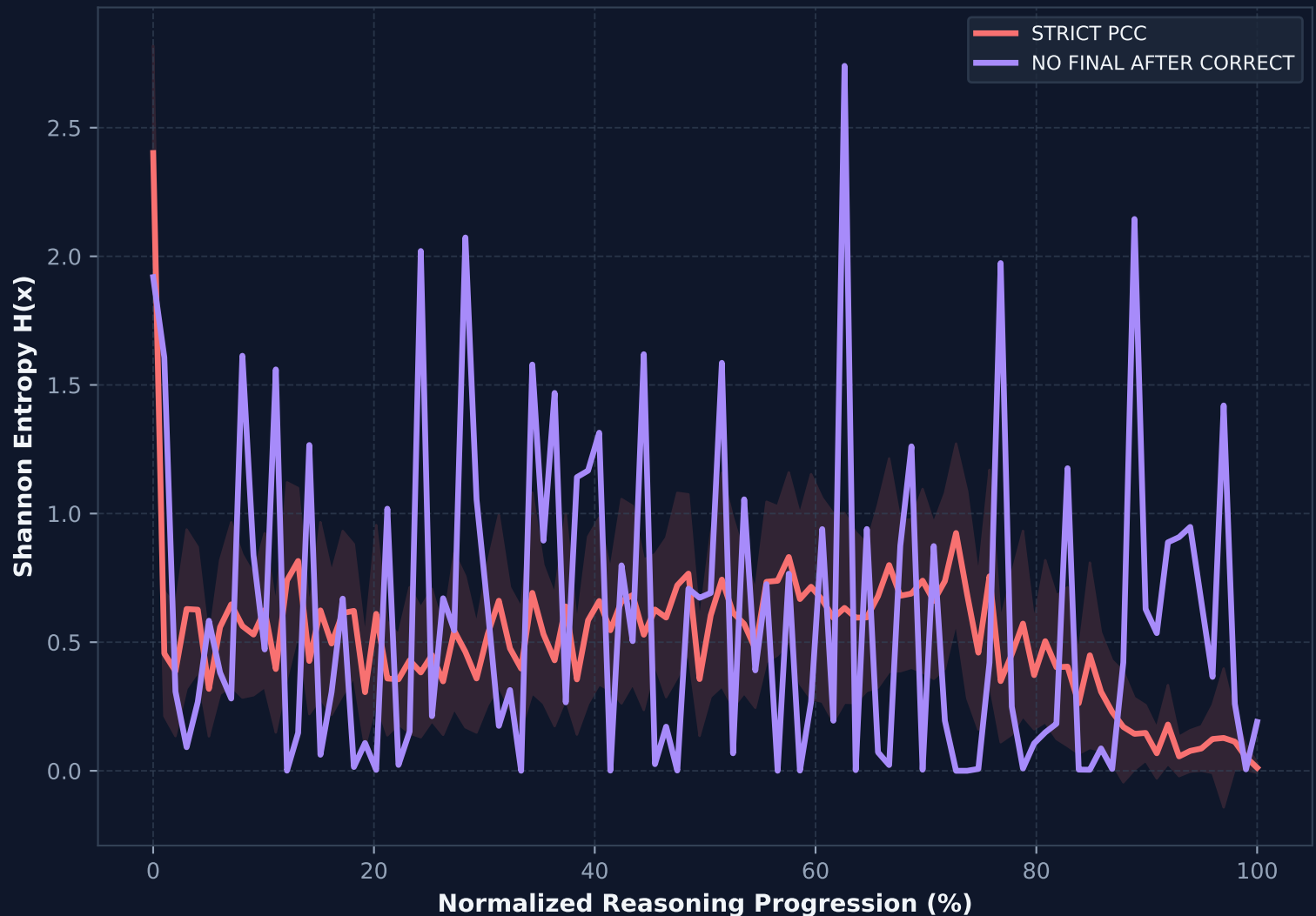


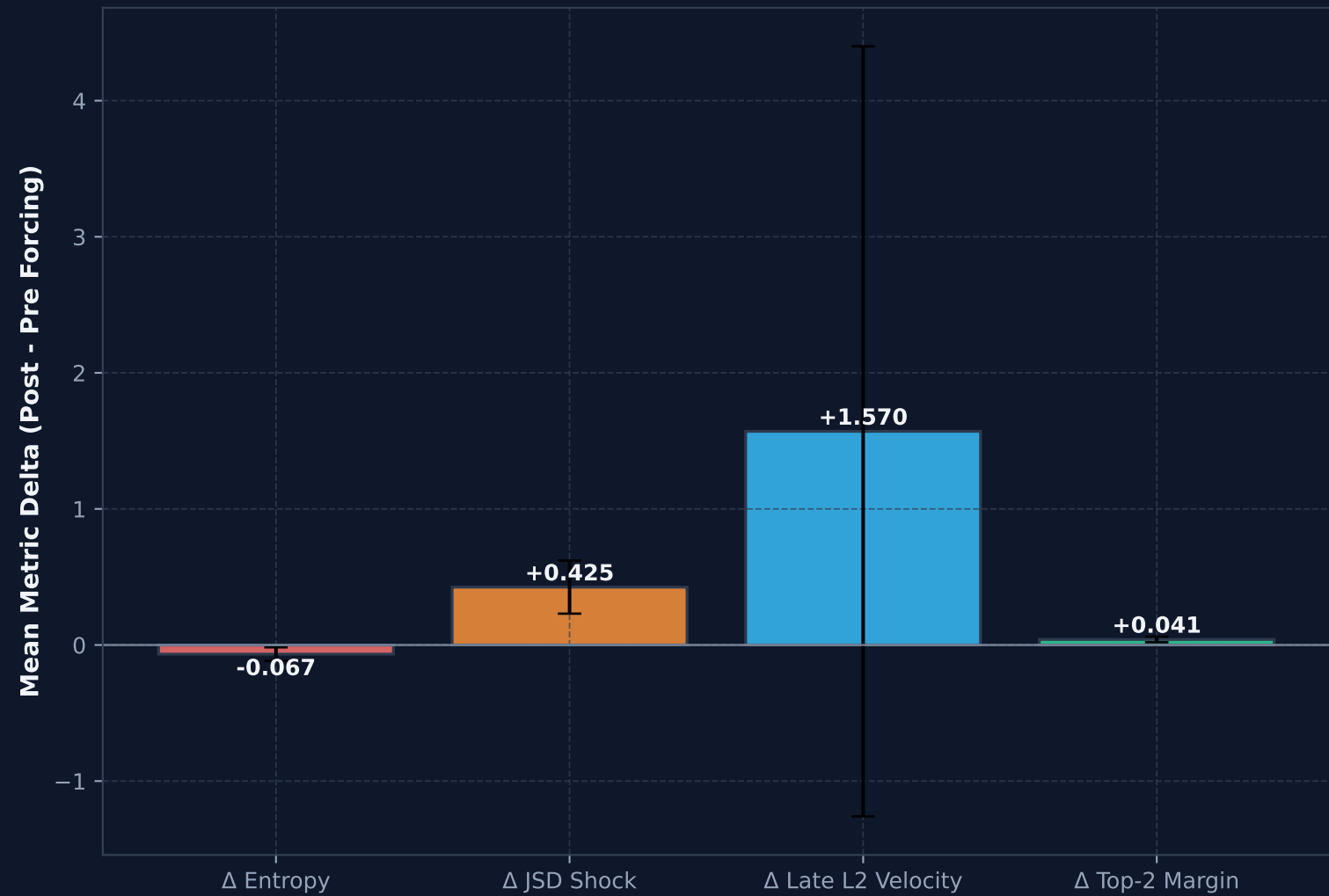
Panel A: Termination Pressure (EOS + $\langle \text{think} \rangle$ Probability)



Panel B: Distributional Instability (Token Entropy)



Panel C: Forced-Budget Perturbation Deltas (Immediate Impact of Scaffold)



Panel D: Textual Degeneration & Looping Markers

